

Xiaomi TV Stick 4K

A feature-loaded media streamer that gets the job done

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Xiaomi recently launched the Xiaomi TV Stick 4K, a feature-packed streaming stick that comes with Android TV 11, Dolby Vision HDR, Dolby ATMOS, and Chromecast built-in, among other features. Is it the streaming stick that will address all your needs? Let's first get the Xiaomi TV Stick 4K price and specifications out of the way.

Design and Remote

The quality of the plastic, used here feels mediocre and our unit has accumulated more than its fair share of scratches and scuff marks during the short testing phase. If you are often on the move and plan on carrying the Xiaomi TV Stick 4K with you, this is something to keep in mind. Although it's less curved compared to the remote that comes with the Realme 4K smart Google TV stick or Amazon's Alexa remote, it's still comfortable to hold and operate and the blocky design feels substantial in hand. The placement of the Google Assistant button above the D-Pad did not make it hard to access.

Performance and quality

This streaming device is powered by Quad-core Cortex-A35 with Mali-G31 MP2 and has 2GB RAM. Out of 8GB of storage, 5.2GB is available for users, which is pretty standard when compared to other streaming dongles in the same price range.

Clearly, this is not stick meant for gaming but it can still handle a few casual games that you may download from Google Play Store. The UI navigation is responsive and smooth. Xiaomi's Patchwall app is basically a content-curating service which I personally don't find very useful.



All popular audio-video codecs including AV1 are supported. The device can detect and trigger Dolby Vision HDR seamlessly. When plugged into our OnePlus Q2 Pro, the device streamed in DolbyVision IQ transmitting a 4:4:4, 8-bit signal which is fine since Dolby Vision uses RGB Tunneling to transmit 4:2:2, 12-bit data within an 8-bit container. The quality of the Dolby Vision content looked fine.

With HDR10 we experienced some inconsistencies. On the OnePlus Q2 Pro, the stick could detect and play HDR10 in shows that don't stream in Dolby Vision. But on an HDR10 monitor, the Xiaomi TV Stick 4K detected and streamed HDR10 content in the standard 4:2:0, 10-bit seamlessly.

HDR10+ is not supported on the Xiaomi Mi TV Stick 4K. This will be a problem only if you consume a lot of content on Prime Video where popular shows like Grand Tour, Boys, etc. output better quality in HDR10+. Otherwise, HDR10+ content is extremely limited. The streaming quality will also largely depend on your TV screen. Automatic frame rate

switching is not supported, but advanced users can manually switch input to 24Hz while watching 24Hz content on Netflix and Prime videos to fix inconsistencies in motion. Google Assistant was responsive and worked flawlessly across apps. As for audio, there is support for both Dolby Atmos and DTS HD audio formats and the quality will depend on your audio setup.

The competition

In India, the Xiaomi TV Stick 4K is primarily up against the FireTV Stick 4K Max and Realme 4K smart Google TV stick. The FireTV Stick 4K Max offers a similar feature set but Amazon's proprietary interface. The FireOS is quite well-designed and has a really well-optimized Prime Video app but it is also quite pushy with ads and promoting partner content. It additionally includes HDR10+ and HLG HDR formats along with automatic frame rate matching that works across popular apps including Prime Videos and Netflix. The FireTV 4K Max is pricier but is often available for discounted prices in recurring sales. The Realme 4K smart Google TV stick runs a cleaner Google TV interface and is also cheaper. It doesn't support Dolby Vision, though.

Xiaomi TV Stick 4K gets the job done

The Xiaomi TV Stick 4K generally performed well in terms of responsiveness and connectivity, although there were some inconsistencies with HDR10 playback on Xiaomi TVs. All popular apps are supported and we had no issues with Android TV features such as Google Assistant and Chromecast built-in, which functioned flawlessly. If you're seeking a stock-ish Android TV interface on a Dolby Vision-compatible screen, we can recommend the Xiaomi TV Stick 4K as an option. On the other hand, if Dolby Vision isn't a priority, you might want to consider the Realme 4K smart Google TV stick instead. Additionally, if you prefer an interface other than Android TV, the Xiaomi Fire TV Stick 4K Max is also a worthy contender. **d**